BAUXITE (ORE)

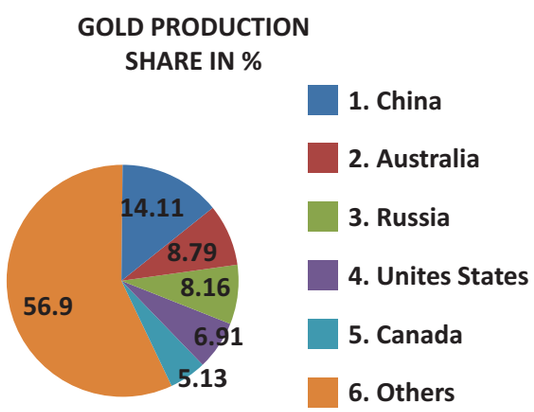
Rank	Country	Production MT	Share in%
1	Australia	83,516,578	29.31
2	China	65,000,000	22.81
3	Brazil	39,244,200	13.77
4	Guinea	31,117,131	10.92
5	India	24,664,632	8.66
	Others		14.53

Gold

Gold is a precious metal which occurs in alluvial or placer deposits or as reefs or lodes in the underground. Gold is used extensively for jewellery and also in dentistry, glass and porcelain dyes, in medicines and other industries. The purity of gold is expressed in terms of carat. China, Australia, Russia, USA and Canada are the leading producers of gold in the world. I

Gold

Rank	Country	Production MT	Share in%
1	China	453,500	14.11
2	Australia	282,421	8.79
3	Russia	262,380	8.16
4	United states	222,211	6.91
5	Canada	165,034	5.13
	Others		56.90





Fool's Gold refers to pyrite of Iron Sulphide because of its similarity in shape and colour to actual gold.

Platinum

Platinum is a rare metal. It is costlier than gold. It has a very high melting point. It is a heavy, malleable, ductile, highly inactive, silverish, white transaction metal. It is one of the densest metal almost twice as dense as lead. Platinum is found with other rare metals such as osmium, Palladium, Iridium and rhodium. Platinum is also used in industrial applications. South Africa is the largest producer of platinum in the world. The other leading producers are Russia, Zimbabwe, Canada and USA.

Platinum

Rank	Country	Production Kg	Share in%
1	South Africa	133,241	71.75
2	Russia	21,860	11.77
3	Zimbabwe	15,110	8.14
4	Canada	9,300	5.01
5	USA	3,891	2.10
	Others		1.33

Non- metallic minerals

The minerals which do not contain metal in them are called as non metallic minerals.

Mica

Mica is a Latin word micare means to shine, to flash or to glitter. Mica has a crystalline and layered structure and can be split into very thin sheets. It does not react to water, acids, oil or solvents. It is lightweight, flexible and strong. It can resist extremely high temperatures or sudden changes in temperature and is able to withstand high voltages and insulate with low power loss. It can absorb or reflect light, which enables a decorative effect and protects against ultra-violet (UV) light.

TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 03.indd 47 1/30/2020 2:19:54 PM